

tionary!!” They discovered the graphical user interface in those labs—the mouse, the windows, the WYSIWYG word processing program, a drawing application, the menus. They were dumbstruck that it was possible to use a computer without typing in a single line of code, the standard way of interfacing with a computer in those days. It wasn’t just a striking revelation for the Apple team: even the engineers at Xerox were awed by the vision of the visitors. PARC scientist Larry Tessler was quoted as saying, “What impressed me was that their questions were better than any I had heard in the seven years I had been at Xerox. From *anybody*—Xerox employee, visitor, university professor, student. Their questions showed that they understood all the implications, and they understood the subtleties, too.” He left Xerox and joined Apple as vice president and chief scientist.

Meanwhile, the most successful Initial Public Offering in the history of business took place on a Friday in the second week of December, 1980. It was the IPO of Apple Computer, Inc. and the shares sold at a heady pace. 4.6 million shares were sold in under an hour. Two young men without college degrees, money, or experience had, within a short period of less than five years, made it to the annual list of the 500 most profitable US industrial corporations. Steve Jobs was worth \$217.5m. He had joined the elite group of the richest men in America.

After the financial success, he wanted more fame. He wanted to be known as the inventor of a great new machine. He was involved in the development of the newest project from Apple at that time, the Lisa. However, he did not have full control over the Lisa and therefore did not want to remain involved in it. He dropped it and took over a small experiment with a new kind of all-in-one concept computer headed by Jef Raskin. Steve Jobs was in a position of power and Raskin was a mere employee at Apple with a really small personal project on his hands, the Macintosh. Raskin already had a working prototype with the display and keyboard designed into a single compact unit. The Macintosh designed by him and his small team of engineers, however, did